Find the Promos

A screenplay-first editorial desk for finding, explaining and reviewing short-form promo opportunities.

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WHY I CHOSE THIS PROBLEM

I have worked on multiple short films and spent 50+ hours in filmmaking. I served as Secretary of the Cinematography Club and currently serve as General Secretary of the Film and Media Council. I was also Producer and Managing Director on a film project selected among the Top 20 at the Indian Film Project (IFP). That exposure made the editorial problem relatable: a strong story moment is not automatically a strong promo. The editor must control what the audience sees, what remains unanswered and where the cut lands.

HOW THE WORKFLOW OPERATES

01 INGEST & PARSE

Upload a ZIP of episode-wise UTF-8 .txt screenplays. The parser preserves episode/scene metadata, dialogue, action, timestamps, camera/shot directions and explicit transition cues.

02 GENERATE CANDIDATES

Build source-backed 20-60 second windows. Check timing, duration, segment order and an opening event within the first three seconds. Cross-episode options can be considered when the visible segments work together.

03 APPLY THE EDITORIAL LENS

Gemini proposes candidates and evaluates them in a separate judging pass. The prompts examine hook, setup, escalation, near-miss/reversal, character and power shifts, reveal-versus-withhold, shot/cut progression, climax tease versus payoff, and the exact unresolved cut-out.

04 VALIDATE & RANK

Code checks candidate structure, combines model scores with configured heuristics, removes highly overlapping cuts and applies diversity penalties. The configured overlap threshold is 0.60 IoU. A score is a ranking aid, not a view or conversion prediction.

05 HUMAN EDITORIAL REVIEW

The editor inspects the rationale and source-timed evidence, then records Good, Bad or Unsure with notes. CSV, JSON, evaluation, ranked-report and editorial-audit exports support handoff and review.

WHAT THE EDITOR SEES

EDITORIAL BREAKDOWN	SHOT & CUT EVIDENCE	SCORING & VALIDATION	FOOTAGE QC HANDOFF
Promo angle, beat progression, character/power dynamics, reveal control and cut-out decision.	Original screenplay cues, event labels, scene IDs and timestamps for traceability.	Weighted score contribution, timing checks, candidate status and validation warnings.	Separates what script can support from checks that require rendered video.

Human sign-off: A model-generated shortlist is not final approval. The editor records a verdict and notes separately from raw model output. A/B: Run A creates the first shortlist; Run B repeats the same screenplay and settings for a repeatability check, not a quality comparison.

CONFIGURED SCORE MODEL

MODEL-JUDGED DIMENSIONS | 70%	CODE-BASED SIGNALS | 30%
Hook 17% · Cliffhanger 20% · Standalone clarity 15% Emotional intensity 7% · Genre fit 5% · Spoiler avoidance 6%	Spoken opening 8% · Dialogue density 6% Length sweet spot 10% · Earlier episode 6%

Weights are configurable heuristics, not weights learned from audience outcomes. In the current rubric, the spoken-opening signal can favour dialogue-led hooks over equally strong visual/action-led openings; this is treated as a known tuning limitation.

What the runs show

The evidence below separates an earlier full-input local-model run from the latest hosted Gemini integration test on a fictional sample.

A. EARLIER FULL INPUT-PACK RUN | LOCAL QWEN3:4B-INSTRUCT

PARSED INPUT	RUN A	RUN B	MANUAL REVIEW OF RUN A TOP 10
50 episodes **100 scenes** **3,727 timed events**	50/50 episodes processed 115 proposed 100 structurally valid 85 judged; 15 unjudged 81 retained after overlap filtering	71 retained after overlap filtering 12 unjudged Both runs were partial.	Good: ranks 2, 4, 6, 10 Unsure: 3, 7, 8 Bad: 1, 5, 9

The earlier local run also recorded 107 model calls, 534,047 input tokens, 58,606 output tokens and 87.8 minutes of aggregate provider-reported call time. This is summed call processing, not end-to-end wall time. A simple 100-episode projection doubled the counts (214 calls; 1,068,094 input tokens; 117,212 output tokens; 175.6 aggregate processing minutes). It assumes similar inputs and outcomes and is not a service-level estimate.

The earlier local full-pack A/B comparison shared 3 exact cuts across the two top-10 lists (30% of each list); Jaccard similarity was 17.6% (3 shared / 17 distinct). The runs were partial and prompt labels also changed, so this is observed repeatability, not a controlled model-quality experiment.

B. LATEST HOSTED GEMINI SMOKE TEST | FICTIONAL ONE-EPISODE SCREENPLAY

PARSER CHECK	RUN A	RUN B	CROSS-RUN OBSERVATION
1 episode; 1 scene 4 dialogue; 3 action 4 camera blocks; 2 cut cues 0 parser warnings	2 proposed; 2 validated; 2 judged 1 retained; 1 deduplicated 51.0 sec; 00:04.00-00:55.00 Score: 79.35	2 proposed; 2 validated; 2 judged 1 retained; 1 deduplicated 54.5 sec; 00:00.50-00:55.00 Score: 89.25	Same ending; different opening (visual/action vs dialogue). The selected intervals overlap by 93.58%; the boundary is not identical. One-episode smoke test only.

This hosted test verifies the deployed parsing and Gemini workflow on a fictional sample; it is not a new full-input-pack run, an audience test or proof of production-scale performance. The 79.35 and 89.25 scores are heuristic editorial rankings, not accuracy percentages.

QUALITY LEARNINGS AND KNOWN FAILURE MODES

WHAT THE REVIEW FOUND

- An early parser scan counted 98 scenes because it missed uppercase scene labels; a case-insensitive scan found 100.
- A judge once treated a reply after a proposed cut as visible inside the promo; judge input was narrowed to selected segments.
- In the manual audit, one cited cliffhanger occurred near the beginning rather than at the ending, one opening action was outside the selected clip, and one cut interrupted a continuing thought.

SCORING LIMITS OBSERVED

- The current scoring rubric gives 8% weight to a spoken opening; a visual/action hook can receive no speech-opening points even when it is compelling.
- The earlier-episode signal gives full value in a single-episode demo, so it is not meaningful at that scale.
- Candidate generation is bounded and can miss a stronger cut.

These are known tuning and search limitations, not solved claims.

SCOPE, HUMAN CONTROL AND NEXT VALIDATION

Script-derived: story hook, escalation, character/information flow, written camera/shot directions, explicit cut/transition cues, reveal/withhold strategy and timestamped candidate boundaries. Requires rendered footage: actual aspect ratio, resolution, composition, framing/safe zones, executed transitions, continuity, camera/subject motion, focus and whether a visual reveal reads on screen. The prototype does not inspect video pixels, edit/render footage, or add music/text overlays.

Implementation checks: The updated parser passed 12 regression tests, and episode, cross-episode and judge prompt smoke tests confirmed camera/cut evidence is carried into the model prompts. The confidential Kuku source pack was not re-run end-to-end after this update. Scale path: Keep parsing and structural checks deterministic; process episodes in batches with configurable model/provider settings, cache and retry controls, then consolidate, de-duplicate and rank for editor review. Parallel workers and a production queue are proposed next steps, not implemented features. The next quality test is an editor-led audit against rendered footage, followed by promo performance data where available.

AI use: ChatGPT assisted with exploration, code, prompt iteration and debugging. Gemini 3.1 Flash-Lite powers the current hosted demo; Qwen3:4b-instruct was used for the earlier local full-pack run. The same model proposes and judges within a run, so the judge pass is not independent validation.

Working assumption: screenplay timestamps are treated as corresponding to the finished episode timeline. Written camera and transition cues are treated as authored intent, not proof of the rendered shot. All final promo choices require human editorial approval.